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2. LIVE FORENSIC INVESTIGATION USING AUTOPSY

Aim

To perform a basic forensic investigation of a Windows system using **Autopsy** and identify files, user activity, browser history, deleted files and other digital evidence.

Procedure

1. Download and Install Autopsy

Download Autopsy from the official website and install it on your PC by following the installation instructions.

2. Create a New Case

Launch Autopsy and select **New Case**. Enter the case name, base directory, and report output location.

3. Enter Case Details

Enter the case number, examiner name, and other required case details. Click **Finish** to create the case.

4. Add a Data Source

Select **Add Data Source** and choose the appropriate data source type, such as a disk image, local disk, or logical files. Browse to the evidence location and select the required source.

5. Configure Ingest Modules

Select the required ingest modules to analyze the evidence. These modules can extract file information, operating system details, user accounts, web history, downloads, cookies, email addresses, and other digital artifacts.

6. Start the Investigation

Click **Finish** to begin processing the selected data source. Autopsy analyzes the evidence and stores the results in the case database.

7. Examine the Investigation Results

After processing is complete, review the available results in the Autopsy interface, including:

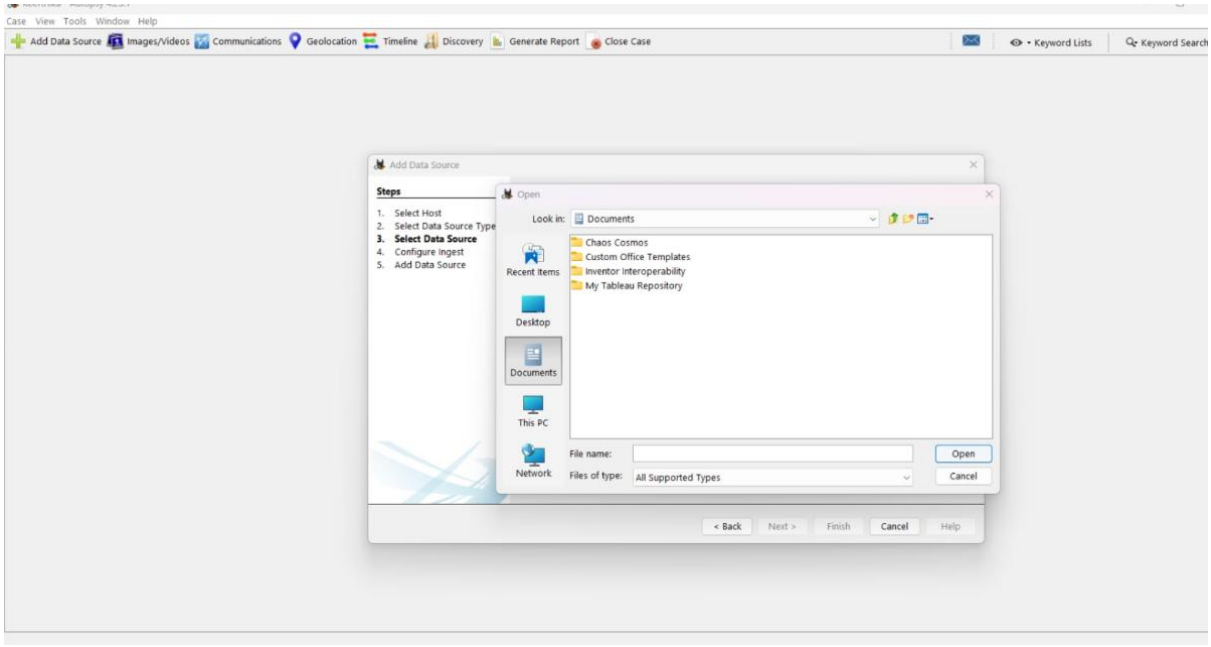
- **Devices Attached:** Examine artifacts related to connected devices, if available.
- **EXIF Metadata:** Inspect image metadata, such as camera details and timestamps.

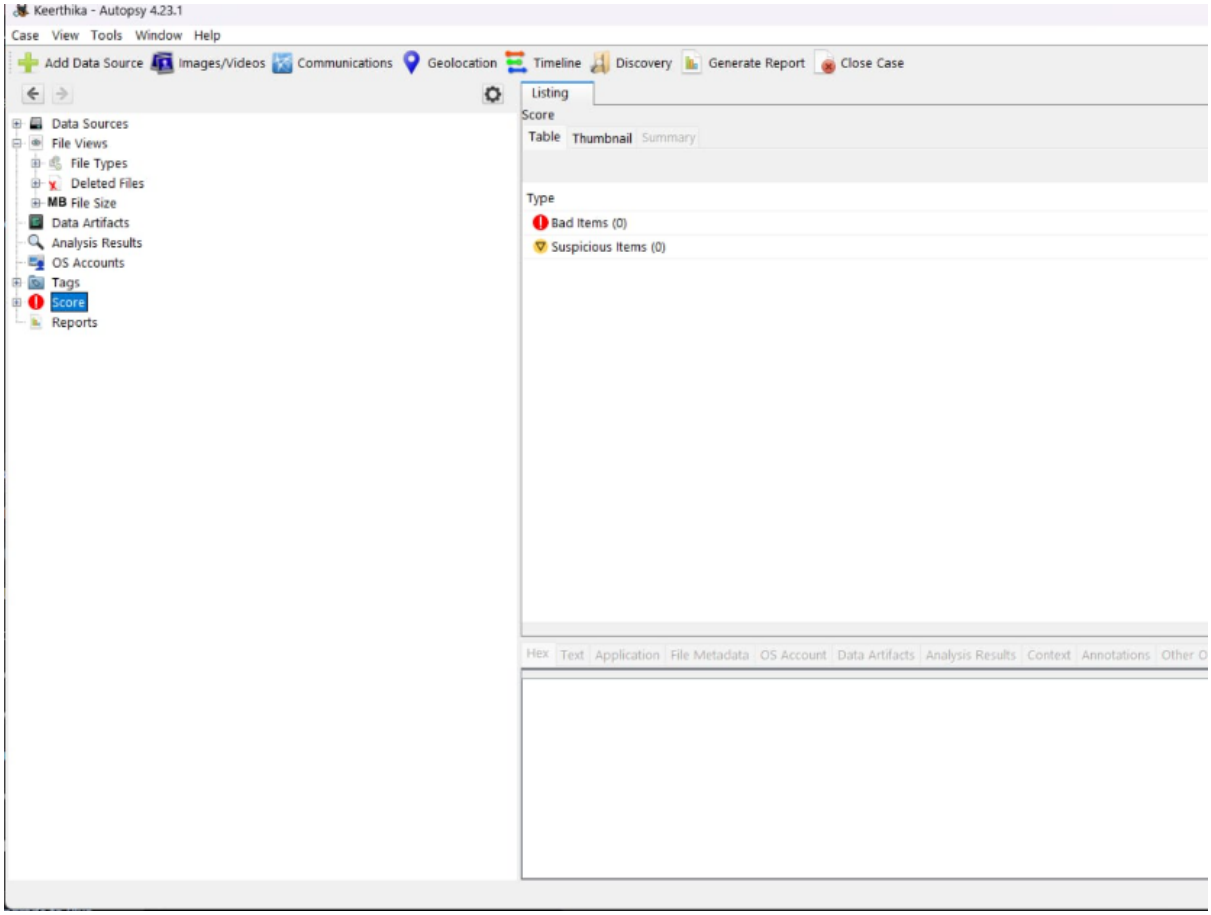
- **Installed Programs:** Identify installed software, where the relevant artifacts are available.
- **Operating System Information:** Examine operating system details.
- **Operating System User Accounts:** Identify user accounts found in the evidence.
- **Recent Documents:** Find artifacts related to recently accessed documents.
- **Web Bookmarks and History:** Examine browsing activity and saved bookmarks.
- **Web Downloads and Search History:** Review download records and search-related artifacts, if available.
- **Web Cookies:** Analyze cookies recovered from browser data.
- **Email Addresses:** Identify email addresses found during artifact extraction.

8. Generate the Investigation Report

Review the relevant findings and generate an investigation report using Autopsy's reporting options. Save the report for documentation and further analysis.

Output:




Keerthika - Autopsy 4.23.1
Case View Tools Window Help
Add Data Source
Images/Videos
Communications
Geolocation
Timeline
Discovery
Generate Report
Close Case
Data Sources
File Views
File Types
Deleted Files
MB File Size
Data Artifacts
Analysis Results
OS Accounts
Tags
Score
Reports
Listing
Score
Table
Thumbnail
Summary
Type
Bad Items (0)
Suspicious Items (0)
Hex
Text
Application
File Metadata
OS Account
Data Artifacts
Analysis Results
Context
Annotations

Report Navigation

- Case Summary
- Tagged Files (0)
- Tagged Images (0)
- Tagged Results (0)

Autopsy Forensic Report

Warning, this report was run before ingest services completed!

HTML Report Generated on 2025/10/12 10:19:44

Case:	exp1
Case Number:	1
Number of data sources in case:	1
Examiner:	Harini

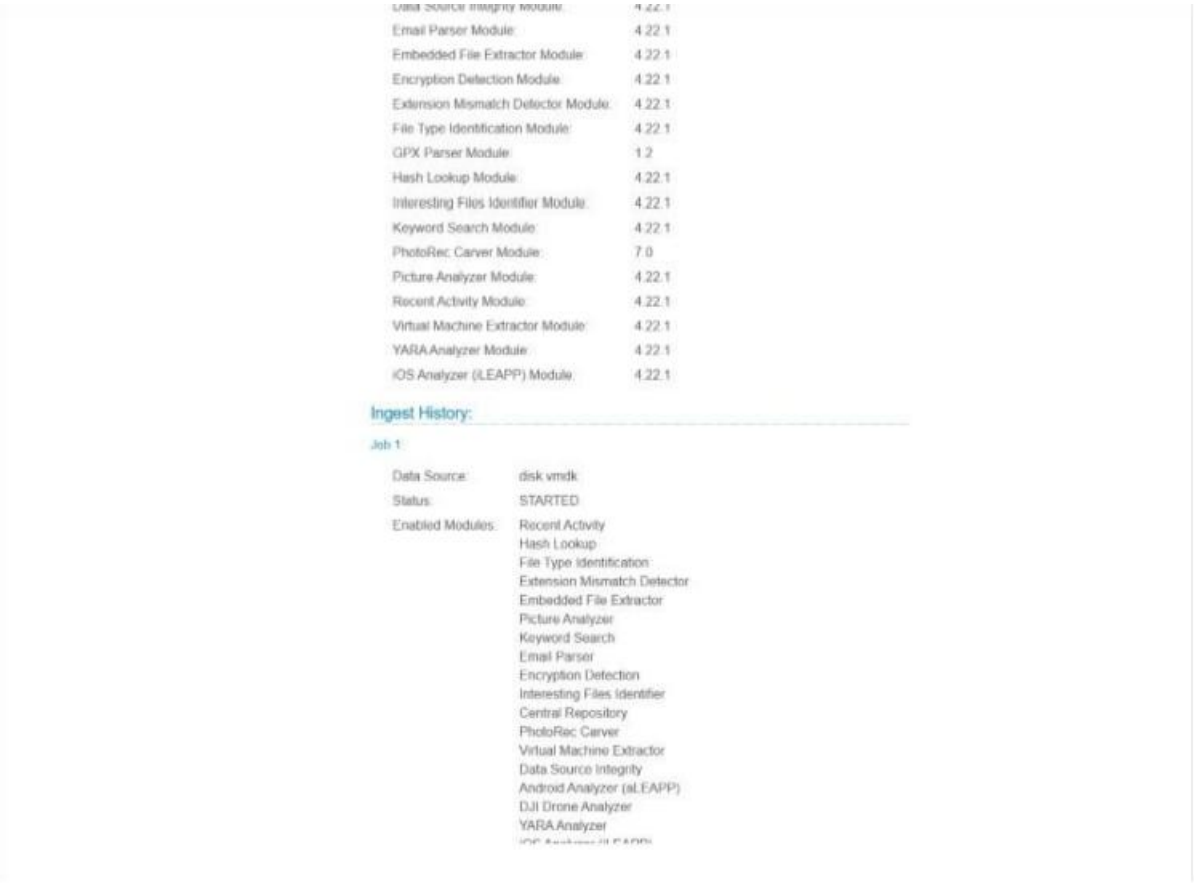
Image Information:

disk.vmdk

Timezone:	Asia/Calcutta
Path:	C:\Users\HP\Downloads\Kali 2025 x64 Customized by zSecurity v1.0\disk.vmdk

Software Information:

Autopsy Version:	4.22.1
Android Analyzer Module:	4.22.1
Android Analyzer (aLEAPP) Module:	4.22.1
Central Repository Module:	4.22.1
DJI Drone Analyzer Module:	4.22.1
Data Source Integrity Module:	4.22.1
Email Parser Module:	4.22.1
Embedded File Extractor Module:	4.22.1
Encryption Detection Module:	4.22.1
Extension Mismatch Detector Module:	4.22.1
File Type Identification Module:	4.22.1
GPX Parser Module:	1.2
Hash Lookup Module:	4.22.1
Interesting Files Identifier Module:	4.22.1





Result

The Windows test system was successfully investigated using **Autopsy**. Relevant digital evidence including user files, browser activity, deleted files and file metadata was identified, examined and documented. A forensic HTML report was successfully generated.